

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 1, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 119:1–16

- 1 Blessed are the undefiled in the way, Who walk in the law of the Lord!
 - 2 Blessed are those who keep His testimonies, Who seek Him with the whole heart!
 - 3 They also do no iniquity; They walk in His ways.
 - 4 You have commanded us To keep Your precepts diligently.
 - 5 Oh, that my ways were directed To keep Your statutes!
 - 6 Then I would not be ashamed, When I look into all Your commandments.
 - 7 I will praise You with uprightness of heart, When I learn Your righteous judgments.
 - 8 I will keep Your statutes; Oh, do not forsake me utterly!
 - 9 How can a young man cleanse his way? By taking heed according to Your word.
 - 10 With my whole heart I have sought You; Oh, let me not wander from Your commandments!
 - 11 Your word I have hidden in my heart, That I might not sin against You.
 - 12 Blessed are You, O Lord! Teach me Your statutes.
 - 13 With my lips I have declared All the judgments of Your mouth.
 - 14 I have rejoiced in the way of Your testimonies, As much as in all riches.
 - 15 I will meditate on Your precepts, And contemplate Your ways.
 - 16 I will delight myself in Your statutes; I will not forget Your word.
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II. Key Summary

- The psalmist opens by saying "Blessed are" twice in a row, and both times what follows

is an action — "walk in the law of the Lord" and "keep His testimonies, who seek Him with the whole heart"; verse 3 adds, "They also do no iniquity; They walk in His ways" (vv. 1–3).

- Verse 4 says God commanded His precepts "to keep them diligently"; right after that the psalmist's words turn into prayer: "Oh, that my ways were directed" and "Oh, do not forsake me utterly" (vv. 4–8).

- In verse 9 the psalmist asks, "How can a young man cleanse his way?" and answers himself, "By taking heed according to Your word"; the verses that follow speak of hiding the word in the heart, declaring it with the lips, meditating on the precepts, and delighting in the statutes (vv. 9–16).

III. Passage Analysis

The Blessed One Is the One Who Lives by God's Word

In the mind of the psalmist, there is a strong and definite connection between being undefiled in the way and walking in the law of the LORD. To walk in the law of the LORD is in fact to be undefiled in the way. [1]

Verses 1 and 2 both say "Blessed are," and each time a verb follows — walk, keep, seek. Verse 3 spells it out: "They also do no iniquity; They walk in His ways." Blessedness is described in things a person does.

The Resolve Turns Straight Into a Prayer

"Oh, that my ways were directed" (v. 5) is both a resolve and a prayer. "For what the law could not do in that it was weak through the flesh" (Romans 8:3), so we must ask God to make our own ways "directed" before we can keep His statutes. [2]

Verse 4 has just said God's precepts are given "to keep them diligently," and by verse 5 the psalmist is saying "Oh, that my ways...", and by verse 8, "Oh, do not forsake me utterly!" Verse 10 runs in the same order: first "With my whole heart I have sought You," then immediately "Oh, let me not wander from Your commandments!"

IV. Reflection Question

You can tell right from wrong — where did those standards come from?

The psalmist asks, "How can a young man cleanse his way?" and his own answer is, "By taking heed according to Your word" (v. 9).

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Psalm 119,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-119/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site, Comprehensive Interpretation of the Bible, Psalm 119, <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/19Psa/19GT119.htm>